

Defend by changing the attack's conditions

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

Defense can capture an attacker, block a line, exchange queens, create an escape square, or launch a forcing counterattack. Choose the method that addresses the actual threat. Passive protection is only one option.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If two enemy pieces coordinate against your king, exchanging one may end the attack even at a small material cost. If you merely add a defender, the opponent may remove it and continue the same combination.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you identify before choosing a defensive move?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The threatened move and the pieces or lines it requires. Look for a way to disrupt one essential condition, then verify the opponent cannot switch to an equally strong threat.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Break the mechanism of the attack.